

WHY MEAL PLANNING IS NON-NEGOTIABLE IN CKD

THE 3 MAJOR DIETARY THREATS

1. Potassium Spike

Hyperkalemia causes fatal arrhythmia. K+ rises fast from bananas, kamote, kamatis, and all broths.

2. Phosphate Overload

Inorganic phosphate (additives) absorbed 90-100%. Causes vascular calcification, bone disease, and death.

3. Sodium/Fluid Overload

Hypertension, pulmonary edema, heart failure. Toyo, patis, bagoong, and fast food are the main culprits.

THE INORGANIC PHOSPHATE PROBLEM

Absorbed **90-100%** (vs 40-60% for natural food phosphate)

Found in additives **E338 to E452** on ingredient labels

**Scan every label** for the word "PHOS" — if present, skip it

The Ingredient Label Test:

1. Flip the package. Read ingredients.

2. Search for any word containing "PHOS"

3. Found one? Put it back. That food is unsafe.

4. No PHOS found? Check sodium and potassium next.

MEAL PREP IS A CLINICAL INTERVENTION

Batch cooking correlates with better serum phosphorus, potassium, and albumin control.

2-3 hours on Sunday = 7 days of kidney-protected eating.

This is part of your prescription — as important as your medications.

| THE FILIPINO DIETARY CHALLENGE   |                                     |                                                   |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Food                             | Risk                                | Clinical Impact                                   |
| Bagoong / Patis / Toyo           | Concentrated Na+ + purines          | Hypertension, hyperuricemia, fluid overload       |
| Sinigang / Nilaga / Bulalo broth | High K+ + purines leach into liquid | Hyperkalemia, gout flares — <b>skip all broth</b> |
| Tocino / Longganisa / Hotdog     | Phosphate preservatives + Na        | Vascular calcification, hypertension              |
| Beer + HFCS softdrinks           | Raise serum uric acid               | Gout flares, renal tubular damage                 |

| SAFE FLAVOR STRATEGY                   | KEY RULE                                          |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Calamansi + garlic + vinegar + pepper  | All four flavors with near-zero Na, K+, phosphate |
| Dried herbs (oregano, bay leaf, thyme) | Safe at any CKD stage                             |
| Toasted garlic (small amount)          | Rich flavor; limit to 1 tsp per meal              |

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CKD PLATE METHOD BY STAGE

Plate proportions shift dramatically as CKD advances. Never use a standard "healthy plate" for Stage 3b or higher.

| Stage                    | Plate Proportions                                                                 | Key Rules                                                                                   |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stage 1-2                | ½ vegetables · ¼ whole grain · ¼ lean protein                                     | Standard healthy plate. No restriction needed unless comorbidities present.                 |
| Stage 3a-3b              | ¼ lean protein · ¼ low-K veg · ¼ complex carb · ¼ low-Na foods                    | Moderate restriction begins. Avoid bagoong, patis, processed meats.                         |
| Stage 4-5 (pre-dialysis) | ¼ very lean protein (0.6 g/kg) · ½ safe veg (leached) · ¼ white rice/refined carb | Strict limits on K+/P/Na. Leach all root vegetables. No broth.                              |
| Dialysis HD/PD           | ■ high protein (1.1-1.2 g/kg) · ¼ low-K veg (leached) · carb + fluid cautious     | <b>MORE protein, STRICTER K+/P/Na/fluid.</b> Dialysis removes protein — do not restrict it. |

DAILY NUTRIENT TARGETS BY CKD STAGE

| Nutrient   | Stage 1-3a    | Stage 3b-4              | Dialysis HD/PD            |
|------------|---------------|-------------------------|---------------------------|
| Protein    | 0.8 g/kg/day  | 0.6-0.8 g/kg/day        | 1.1-1.2 g/kg/day          |
| Sodium     | <2,000 mg/day | <2,000 mg/day           | <2,000 mg/day             |
| Potassium  | Unrestricted  | <2,500 mg/day           | <2,000 mg/day             |
| Phosphorus | <900 mg/day   | <800 mg/day             | <800 mg/day               |
| Fluid      | Unrestricted  | Depends on urine output | 500-750 mL + urine output |

BEST PROTEIN SOURCES BY CKD STAGE

| Protein Source                  | Stage 1-3a | Stage 3b-4 | Dialysis | Why                               |
|---------------------------------|------------|------------|----------|-----------------------------------|
| Egg white                       | ✓✓✓        | ✓✓✓        | ✓✓✓      | Very low P, high-quality protein  |
| Chicken breast (skin off)       | ✓✓✓        | ✓✓         | ✓✓✓      | Lean, moderate P, versatile       |
| Fish (bangus/tilapia)           | ✓✓✓        | ✓✓         | ✓✓       | Omega-3; watch serving size       |
| Pork tenderloin (lean)          | ✓✓         | ✓          | ✓✓       | Lower fat than pork belly         |
| Whole egg                       | ✓✓         | ✓✓         | ✓✓       | Yolk has higher P; limit to 1/day |
| Organ meats (atay/utak)         | ✗          | ✗          | ✗        | Extreme purine + phosphate        |
| Processed meats (tocino/hotdog) | ✗          | ✗          | ✗        | Phosphate preservatives           |

THE CKD SUNDAY PREP SYSTEM — 3 HOURS, 7 DAYS PROTECTED

| Time               | Task                       | Details                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hour 1 9-10 AM     | Leach vegetables           | Set water to leach kamote, patatas, singkamas, gabi. Start rice cooker. Marinate proteins (vinegar + calamansi + garlic + pepper — no toyo).                 |
| Hour 2 10-11 AM    | Cook protein batches       | Boil chicken/fish in batches — drain ALL cooking liquid immediately. Steam or bake as alternative. Portion 70g (pre-dialysis) or 90g (dialysis) per serving. |
| Hour 3 11 AM-12 PM | Portion + label containers | Fill containers: protein + rice + vegetable. Label each: Day / Meal (B/L/D/S) / Contents / K+ level. Refrigerate 3-4 days, freeze the rest. Pack go-bag.     |

4-STEP CONTAINER LABELING SYSTEM

Label every container with 4 pieces of info:

1. Day — Mon / Tue / Wed...

2. Meal — B (Breakfast) / L (Lunch) / D (Dinner) / S (Snack)

3. Contents — Protein + vegetable + carb

4. K+ level — LOW / MOD / HIGH (so you know the risk)

ESSENTIAL PREP TOOLS

• Digital food scale (gram-accurate)

• Individual portion containers — 4 sets × 3 days = 12

• Leaching bowls (large, for 10x water volume)

• Kitchen timer for leach timing

• Marker/labels for container ID

SEASONING WITHOUT SODIUM — FILIPINO FLAVORS

| Instead of         | Use                                                   |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Toyo (soy sauce)   | Calamansi juice + small garlic                        |
| Patis (fish sauce) | Vinegar + crushed garlic + tiny amount toyo           |
| Bagoong            | Miso paste 1 tsp + calamansi (far lower Na + purines) |
| MSG / Magic Sarap  | Toasted garlic + dried herbs (oregano, bay leaf)      |
| Table salt         | Calamansi + pepper + lemon zest                       |

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LEACHING TECHNIQUE — REDUCES POTASSIUM BY 30-50%

| Step   | Action                                                        | Why it matters                                                 |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Step 1 | Peel completely — kamote, gabi, patatas, singkamas            | Most K+ is concentrated near the surface/skin                  |
| Step 2 | Slice thin (3-5 mm thick)                                     | More surface area = more K+ released during soak               |
| Step 3 | Soak 2+ hours in 10x warm water — change water once at 1 hour | K+ diffuses from vegetable into water. Discard ALL soak water. |
| Step 4 | Boil in fresh water, drain immediately                        | NEVER reuse cooking liquid. Final K+ is in that water.         |

| SAFE — Low K+ (no leaching)                                                                                                    | Vegetable             | Soak Time                 | K+ Reduction |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------|--------------|
| Sayote · Upo · Ampalaya · Labanos · Sitaw (1 cup max) Bell pepper · Cabbage · Cucumber · Lettuce · Talong Kangkong (½ cup max) | Kamote / sweet potato | 4 hrs, change water at 2h | ~50%         |
|                                                                                                                                | Gabi (taro)           | 3 hours                   | ~45%         |
|                                                                                                                                | Patatas (potato)      | 2 hours                   | ~40%         |
| REQUIRE LEACHING or AVOID                                                                                                      | Singkamas             | 2 hours                   | ~35%         |
|                                                                                                                                | Kamatis               | 1 hour                    | ~30%         |
| Leach before use: Kamote, Gabi, Patatas, Singkamas, Kamatis                                                                    |                       |                           |              |
| Avoid (very high K+): Saging/banana (Stage 3+), Spinach, Alugbati, Avocado                                                     |                       |                           |              |

COOKING METHOD RANKINGS (BEST → WORST FOR CKD)

| Rank | Method                 | Rating | Notes                                                        |
|------|------------------------|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Steaming               | ✓✓✓    | No added Na, retains nutrients, no K+ transfer issue         |
| 2    | Boiling (drain liquid) | ✓✓     | Leaches K+ into water — always discard cooking water         |
| 3    | Grilling / Baking      | ✓✓     | No added Na; watch marinades for soy/fish sauce              |
| 4    | Stir-fry (minimal oil) | ✓      | Fast; watch sodium from sauces — use calamansi/vinegar only  |
| 5    | Deep frying            | XX     | Adds phosphate from breading/batter; avoid whenever possible |
| 6    | Pressure cooking       | X      | Retains ALL minerals; no leaching benefit for K+ reduction   |

CKD-ADAPTED FILIPINO DISHES

| Dish      | What to Change                                              | Why                                                  |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Sinigang  | Eat meat only; skip ALL broth                               | K+ and purines leach into broth                      |
| Nilaga    | Eat beef/pork/chicken only; discard broth                   | Same — all K+ in the liquid                          |
| Bulalo    | Small serving of boiled meat only; no broth at all          | Bone broth = highest purine + K+ liquid              |
| Adobo     | Vinegar + small garlic + pepper only; skip toyo             | Each tbsp toyo = ~1,000 mg Na                        |
| Tinola    | Chicken meat only; no broth; replace sayote for malunggay   | Malunggay = high K+; broth concentrates K+           |
| Paksiw    | Vinegar-based = OK; watch portion size                      | Fish sauce forbidden; vinegar safe                   |
| Kare-kare | Eat vegetables + oxtail (no broth); miso instead of bagoong | Bagoong = concentrated Na + purine                   |
| Dinuguan  | AVOID                                                       | Pork blood + organ meat = extreme purine + phosphate |
| Sisig     | AVOID                                                       | Organ meat (atay/utak) = extreme purine + phosphate  |

## FILIPINO FAST FOOD — TRAFFIC LIGHT RATINGS

## GLOBAL FAST FOOD RULES — APPLY THESE AT EVERY CHAIN:

- Take phosphate binder WITH the first bite of every meal • Water only — no carbonated drinks, softdrinks, or sports drinks
- Remove ALL fried-chicken skin and breading (most phosphate additives are in the coating) • Skip all gravy and broth-based items
- No burgers (phosphate-enriched buns) • When in doubt: skip it

|                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>MANG INASAL</b><br><b>BEST OPTION</b>                   | <b>OK TO ORDER:</b><br>• Pecho (breast) 1 pc — skin completely off • Paa (leg) — skin off • Plain rice 1 cup • Vinegar / calamansi dip (small amount)                                               | <b>AVOID:</b><br>• Sinigang/soup — high K+/Na broth • Goto / Palabok — organ meat / shrimp • Peanut sauce — high K+ • All softdrinks • Unlimited rice trap                                                                                                         |
|                                                            | <b>Best order:</b> 1 pc pecho (skin off) + 1 cup plain rice + water<br><i>Grilled not fried = no breading = no phosphate additives.</i>                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>JOLLIBEE</b><br><b>CAUTION</b>                          | <b>OK TO ORDER:</b><br>• Chicken Joy 1 pc — skin completely off, no gravy • Plain steamed rice 1 cup • Peach Mango Pie — Stage 1-3 occasional only                                                  | <b>AVOID:</b><br>• Spaghetti — high Na + processed meat • All burgers — phosphate in bun + patty • Palabok — shrimp-based, high P • Jolly Hotdog — processed + phosphate • Gravy — phosphate thickener + very high Na • Peach Float / softdrinks — phosphoric acid |
|                                                            | <b>Best order:</b> 1 pc Chicken Joy (skin off, no gravy) + plain rice + water<br><i>Chicken Joy breading contains phosphate additives — remove ALL skin and breading.</i>                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>MCDONALD'S PH</b><br><b>CAUTION</b>                     | <b>OK TO ORDER:</b><br>• McChicken patty — remove the bun completely • Plain steamed rice 1 cup • Grilled chicken if available                                                                      | <b>AVOID:</b><br>• All burgers — enriched buns = phosphate leavening • Large fries — very high K+/Na • McFlurry / Sundae — dairy + additives, high P • All iced coffees — dairy + sweetener + phosphate • All sodas                                                |
|                                                            | <b>Best order:</b> McChicken patty (bun removed) + plain rice + mineral water<br><i>Small fries Stage 1-3 occasional only. No sodas.</i>                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>KFC PHILIPPINES</b><br><b>HIGH RISK</b>                 | <b>OK TO ORDER:</b><br>• Original Recipe 1 piece ONLY — skin and breading COMPLETELY removed • Plain rice 1 cup                                                                                     | <b>AVOID:</b><br>• Gravy — extreme P + Na • Coleslaw — high Na dressing • Twister / Zinger — phosphate-enriched tortilla + bun • Mashed potato — instant mix + gravy = extreme P + Na • Corn on the cob — very high K+ • All sides and all drinks except water     |
|                                                            | <b>Best order:</b> 1 pc Original Recipe (all skin and breading stripped) + plain rice + water<br><i>WARNING: Highest-risk chain. Heavy phosphate additives in all breading. Strip to bare meat.</i> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>CHOWKING</b><br><b>CAUTION</b>                          | <b>OK TO ORDER:</b><br>• Plain steamed rice 1 cup • Fried chicken 1 pc — skin removed • Tokwa't baboy small serving — limit soy sauce                                                               | <b>AVOID:</b><br>• Halo-halo — very high K+: ube + beans + banana • Siopao — processed pork + high Na dough • Dimsum — high Na + phosphate • Congee/lugaw/arroz caldo — very high Na broth • All noodle dishes — phosphate-enriched + high Na                      |
|                                                            | <b>Best order:</b> Plain rice + 1 pc fried chicken (skin off) + water<br><i>Avoid all broth-based dishes.</i>                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>KENNY ROGERS ROASTERS</b><br><b>CAUTION</b>             | <b>OK TO ORDER:</b><br>• Rotisserie chicken 1 quarter — skin completely off, no sauce • Plain steamed rice 1 cup • Corn on cob ½ cob only (skip if Stage 3+ with K+ restriction)                    | <b>AVOID:</b><br>• Macaroni salad — high P: mayo + dairy + high Na • Mashed potato with gravy — extreme P + Na • Coleslaw — high Na dressing • Chicken soup/porridge — very high Na broth • All sauces / dips / marinades — added phosphates + Na                  |
|                                                            | <b>Best order:</b> Rotisserie quarter (skin off, no sauce) + 1 cup plain rice + water<br><i>Safer than KFC — roasted not fried, no breading. Danger is in the SIDES.</i>                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>GOLDBLOCKS / RED RIBBON</b><br><b>BETTER FOR SNACKS</b> | <b>OK TO ORDER:</b><br>• Plain pancit bihon small serving (watch Na) • Puto 2 pieces occasionally • Chicken + rice meal sets moderate (watch sauce)                                                 | <b>AVOID:</b><br>• Cakes/pastries — phosphate leavening in baking powder • Ensaymada — high P: butter + cheese • Leche flan / custard — very high P: egg yolks + dairy • Fruit salad — high K+: fruit cocktail + cream                                             |
|                                                            | <b>Best order:</b> Puto 2 pcs + plain rice + water<br><i>Better for snacks than full meals. Avoid ALL dairy-based desserts and baked goods.</i>                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

## WHAT TO DRINK AT ANY CHAIN

## SAFE DRINKS

- Plain mineral / still water — always the best choice
- Unsweetened calamansi juice (no syrup)
- Plain iced tea unsweetened
- Hot black coffee (no milk, no sugar) — mild urate-lowering effect

## AVOID COMPLETELY

- All carbonated softdrinks (Coke/Pepsi/Sprite/Royal) — phosphoric acid
- All sweetened iced teas / lemonades (HFCS)
- Fruit juices commercial — high K+ + fructose
- Energy drinks (Red Bull/Sting/C2 Power) — K+ + phosphate
- Sports drinks (Gatorade/Pocari) — high K+
- Iced coffee with milk/creamers — dairy phosphate

## CONVENIENCE STORES — 7-ELEVEN / MINISTOP / FAMILYMART

| Item                                      | Notes                                            | Stage Safety   |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Plain white rice (hot counter)            | Safest convenience item; 1 cup only              | All stages ✓   |
| Hard-boiled egg                           | 1 egg; excellent portable protein; very low P    | All stages ✓   |
| Plain crackers (Sky Flakes/Fita original) | 2-3 pcs; check label for original low-Na version | All stages ✓   |
| Bottled mineral water                     | Always choose over any other beverage            | All stages ✓   |
| Apple or pear                             | Lower-K+ fruit; safe emergency snack             | All stages ✓   |
| Unsweetened soy milk (small carton)       | Moderate P; Stage 1-3 occasional only            | Stage 1-3 only |
| Banana                                    | High K+ — physician clearance required           | Stage 1-2 only |

## ALWAYS AVOID AT CONVENIENCE STORES:

- All instant noodles (Lucky Me/Nissin/Payless) — extreme Na + phosphate in seasoning
- Processed meats (hotdog/longganisa/tocino) — nitrates + phosphate preservatives
- Canned goods (sardines/cornd beef) — high Na + phosphate in brine
- Flavored chips — often contain KCl (potassium chloride) salt substitute = fatal in CKD
- Energy/sports drinks (Red Bull/Gatorade/Pocari) — high K+ + phosphate
- Carbonated drinks — phosphoric acid = 100% absorbed
- Dairy desserts (pudding/yogurt/flavored milk) — high phosphate

**SURVIVAL MEAL (Convenience Store Emergency):** 1 plain rice + 1 hard-boiled egg + 2 crackers + mineral water = very low K+/P/Na. Take phosphate binder with the egg.

## CARINDERIA / TURO-TURO GUIDE

## USUALLY SAFE:

- Plain white rice
- Inihaw na isda (bangus/tilapia) — no sauce
- Boiled/steamed chicken — no broth served
- Pinakbet small serving — leached veg, miso not bagoong
- Chopsuey with sayote / upo / cabbage / carrots
- Ensaladang talong small serving — no bagoong

## ALWAYS AVOID:

- ANY sinigang / nilaga / bulalo / sabaw — skip broth
- Kare-kare with bagoong
- Dinuguan — pork blood + organ meat
- Sisig — organ meat
- Goto / offal dishes
- Processed meat dishes
- Halo-halo

**Script to say at carinderia:** "Pakihingan ng toyo at bagoong. Wag lagyan ng maraming asin. Para sa kidney ko."

**7-DAY MEAL PLAN — CKD STAGE 3b-4 (PRE-DIALYSIS)**

Protein 0.6-0.8 g/kg/day | K+ &lt;2,500 mg/day | P &lt;900 mg/day | Na &lt;2,000 mg/day | All proteins = 70 g serving

| Day | Breakfast                             | Lunch                                                    | Merienda                              | Dinner                                                        |
|-----|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon | 1 boiled egg + ½ cup rice + calamansi | Baked chicken 70g + ¾ cup rice + steamed sayote          | 2 crackers + 1 apple                  | Steamed tilapia 70g + ½ cup rice + blanched cabbage           |
| Tue | Soft-boiled egg + 1 slice white bread | Tinola chicken 70g (meat only, no broth) + ¾ cup rice    | 1 pear                                | Pork tenderloin 70g + ½ cup rice + steamed upo                |
| Wed | Plain champorado ¾ cup (no evap milk) | Steamed fish 70g + ¾ cup rice + sautéed sayote           | 2 Sky Flakes crackers                 | Adobo chicken 70g (vinegar-based, no toyo) + ½ cup rice       |
| Thu | 1 egg + ½ cup sinangag (no toyo)      | Boiled chicken 70g + ¾ cup rice + blanched sitaw (1 cup) | 1 small apple                         | Baked bangus 70g + ½ cup rice + steamed ampalaya              |
| Fri | 1 boiled egg + ½ cup plain rice       | Tinolang isda 70g (meat only) + ¾ cup rice + sayote      | 2 crackers + water                    | Steamed chicken 70g + ½ cup rice + chopsuey (no oyster sauce) |
| Sat | Soft scrambled egg (1) + ½ cup rice   | Paksiw na isda 70g + ¾ cup rice + ensaladang talong      | 1 pear                                | Grilled chicken 70g (no marinade) + ½ cup rice + sautéed upo  |
| Sun | 1 egg + 1 slice white bread           | Chicken breast 70g + ¾ cup rice + steamed labanos        | Banana (Stage 1-2 only) or 2 crackers | Baked tilapia 70g + ½ cup rice + blanched ampalaya            |

**7-DAY MEAL PLAN — DIALYSIS HD/PD**

Protein 1.1-1.2 g/kg/day | K+ &lt;2,000 mg/day | P &lt;800 mg/day | Na &lt;2,000 mg/day | All proteins = 90 g serving | Fluid restriction applies

| Day | Breakfast                                | Lunch                                                       | Merienda           | Dinner                                                     |
|-----|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon | 2 boiled eggs + ½ cup rice               | Chicken breast 90g (skin off) + ¾ cup rice + steamed sayote | 2 crackers + water | Fish 90g + ½ cup rice + blanched cabbage                   |
| Tue | 2-egg scramble + ½ cup rice              | Baked pork tenderloin 90g + ¾ cup rice + steamed upo        | 1 apple (medium)   | Grilled chicken 90g + ½ cup rice + sautéed ampalaya        |
| Wed | 1 egg + ¾ cup rice + 1 slice white bread | Fish 90g (steamed) + ¾ cup rice + sayote                    | 2 Sky Flakes       | Chicken 90g + ½ cup rice + steamed labanos                 |
| Thu | 2 boiled eggs + ½ cup rice               | Pork tenderloin 90g + ¾ cup rice + steamed sitaw ½ cup      | 1 pear             | Baked bangus 90g + ½ cup rice + chopsuey (no oyster sauce) |
| Fri | 2-egg scramble + ½ cup rice              | Chicken breast 90g + ¾ cup rice + blanched cabbage          | 2 crackers         | Tilapia 90g + ½ cup rice + sautéed sayote                  |
| Sat | 2 eggs + ½ cup sinangag (no toyo)        | Baked fish 90g + ¾ cup rice + steamed upo                   | 1 small apple      | Chicken 90g + ½ cup rice + blanched ampalaya               |
| Sun | 2 boiled eggs + ½ cup rice               | Pork 90g + ¾ cup rice + steamed labanos                     | 2 crackers + water | Fish 90g + ½ cup rice + blanched cabbage                   |

THE CKD GO-BAG KIT — NEVER BE CAUGHT WITHOUT A SAFE OPTION

| Item                                        | What it is                                     | Why essential                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Portioned home-cooked meal (cold pack)      | Your leached, portion-controlled prepared meal | Best nutrition; nothing safer at any fast food location       |
| Mineral water 500mL bottle                  | Still water, no additives                      | Never rely on fast food drinks; phosphoric acid is everywhere |
| Phosphate binder (labeled pill case)        | In case labeled with meal times                | Take with FIRST bite of every meal — no exceptions            |
| Calamansi juice (small bottle, unsweetened) | Flavor safely without Na+                      | Replaces patis/toyo/soy sauce; zero Na in pure juice          |
| Sky Flakes crackers (2-3 pcs in zip bag)    | Safe emergency snack                           | Low Na, low K+, low P — the safest packaged snack             |
| Apple or pear                               | Safe low-K+ fruit snack                        | Emergency snack; all stages safe                              |
| Labeled meal prep container                 | Compartments: Day / Meal / Contents / K+ level | Prevents confusion; enables portion control away from home    |

PRACTICAL TIPS & FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

| Question                                         | Answer                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Can I eat delivery food?                         | With great caution. Mang Inasal pecho (no sauce) + rice = generally acceptable. Avoid all burger delivery, noodle dishes, soups, and any softdrinks.                                             |
| What if I forgot my phosphate binder?            | Call your doctor. Do NOT eat a high-phosphate meal without your binder. Choose rice + egg + water (the survival combo) and take your binder as soon as you get home.                             |
| How do I survive a boodle fight or lechon party? | Eat: plain rice (1 cup) + boiled meat (small serving, no broth). Skip: sisig, dinuguan, organ meats, all soups/broth, all softdrinks, beer. Bring your own calamansi water and phosphate binder. |
| Is restaurant delivery safe?                     | Generally no — cooking method and sodium content are unknown. If you must order: Mang Inasal pecho delivery is the most reliable safe option. Always skip the sauces.                            |
| What about instant noodles in emergencies?       | Never. Lucky Me/Nissin seasoning packets contain extreme Na (1,500+ mg per packet) + phosphate additives. Always carry crackers + egg instead.                                                   |
| Can I have merienda from a bakery?               | Only plain puto (2 pcs max). Avoid ensaymada (high P butter+cheese), leche flan (high P egg yolk+dairy), all cakes/pastries (phosphate leavening), and all dairy-based baked goods.              |

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This document was prepared by W. G. M. Rivero, MD, FPCP, DPSN (PRC 0105184) for patient education purposes. It is not a substitute for individualized medical advice. Dietary requirements vary by CKD stage, comorbidities, laboratory values, and medications. Always follow the specific dietary prescription given by your nephrologist.